

Houmanoids, Inc. — SignalOS Diligence Report

Private seed-stage · Humanoid/quadruped robots-as-a-service · Verdict: PASS at offered terms (\$54M pre / \$60M post) · 2026-09-02 · Two-mode diligence: the data room as claim ledger, verification at independent primaries

What the company is

Houmanoids deploys robot dogs as a subscription service (\$6,000/month list) to law enforcement, schools, property managers, construction sites, and retail — the pitch is American software, service, and (eventually) assembly wrapped around imported robot hardware. Delaware C-corp (Sept 2025), a Japan KK, and a Shanghai WFOE (侯盟乐德, registered Feb 2026, \$50M subscribed / \$0 paid-in). Founders: Taylor Hou (CEO — 5x founder: APM Help/Syndi, Amoriss, Fyxed; Mandarin speaker, ex-Goldwind supply chain) and Afik Cohen (CTO — ex-TikTok US, Perplexity, Airbnb). Seed sought on an uncapped SAFE with MFN at a self-asserted \$54M pre-money.

A structural note on the source: the company states its own AI system wrote most of the data room, and that reads are logged. Internal consistency across such documents proves nothing (one generator, one voice) — so every load-bearing claim below was tested outside the room.

Claim-by-claim: what they say vs. what verifies

Their claim	What verification found	Confidence
“Made in USA robots”; compliance is the moat	Their own §889 page inverts this: the deployed fleet is a Deep Robotics M20 (Hangzhou, PRC) with Hesai lidar — on the DoD §1260H list — and a Chinese camera ODM. Verbatim: “We cannot yet execute an affidavit-grade §889 certification.” US assembly is a Dec-2026 <i>plan</i> : the FTZ commitment is verbal, the plant agreement unexecuted, the FCC exemption a “founders’ understanding” (their labels)	HIGH — their own filings
First paying customer Sept 1, 2026	The customer is Amoriss — the CEO’s own property company . The one completed arm’s-length pilot was free and ended in an actuator failure . First unaffiliated revenue is <i>projected</i> for October	HIGH

Their claim	What verification found	Confidence
\$197M pipeline / \$5.57M MRR potential; 7 agreements	Their own footnote: “indicative sizing, not contracted revenue” — CRM math at full theoretical scope. Reality: 3 signed LOIs (one related-party), 4 pending, 1 failed free pilot	MED-HIGH
\$3M seed at \$54M pre	No Form D on EDGAR (confirmed clean search) — terms have no independent anchor. Balance sheet: founder loans (\$450k Syndi converting at a \$10M cap + \$98k Hou Ventures) and \$10,553 cash at July 31, bridged by a one-off \$77k equipment sale	MED
FCC DA-26-786 / American Security Robotics Act timing thesis	Could not be independently verified (access degraded). Load-bearing in both directions: real → an existential ban lands on their current product with only an unexecuted mitigation; overstated → a moat pillar evaporates	LOW — flagged

The \$889 analysis (the decisive finding)

Federal rules (§889, 2 CFR 200.216) bar covered Chinese telecom/video equipment for federally-funded buyers — which describes **both** of Houmanoids’ anchor verticals: sheriffs (federal grants) and schools (E-Rate). The product as deployed today is a PRC-origin quadruped carrying a §1260H-listed sensor, and the company concedes it cannot certify compliance — which its own anchor LOI requires *before deployment*. The “compliance moat” is therefore a bet that they onshore assembly and secure FCC approval **before the ban bites their pipeline**. That is a regulatory-arbitrage venture bet with an unexecuted mitigation — a legitimate thing to bet on, but the opposite of a moat that exists today, and the memo’s headline framing inverts it.

The unit-economics base rate

Their own memo cites the anchor against itself: **Knightscope — a decade of public security-RaaS actuals at comparable price points — has spent \$1.38–\$1.71 to deliver every \$1.00 of service revenue, every year FY21–25**, and has never reached unit profitability. Houmanoids’ counter-thesis is deployment density (60 dogs in one parish → ~31% cost ratio). Density is a spreadsheet scenario, labeled “planning” in their own model. The 75-unit cash model through 2028 rests entirely on it.

The honesty-alpha finding (genuinely in their favor)

This is **not** a masking case — it is the opposite. The room voluntarily discloses: the PRC robot base, the related-party first customer and founder loans, the failed pilot, and hedges its weakest claims in plain language (“founders’ understanding,” “nothing is executed,” “indicative sizing”). On

the desk's honesty framework this is a high-integrity disclosure posture, and it speaks well of the founders as future counterparties. It does not change the verdict: an honestly-disclosed hard bet at a rich price is still a pass. Candor prices the relationship, not the SAFE.

Verdict and reopen conditions

PASS at \$60M post on an uncapped SAFE. The desk has no edge underwriting a pre-revenue regulatory-arbitrage bet at a founder-asserted venture price — and the honest documents themselves say the moat is unbuilt.

It becomes a conversation when all three exist: 1. A **capped** instrument at a defensible number (the uncapped-MFN structure on self-asserted terms is the wrong risk for outside money at this stage); 2. The moat **executed, not described**: signed FTZ assembly agreement + the FCC approval instrument in hand; 3. **One arm's-length paying deployment surviving 90 days** without hardware failure.

Provenance: how Amoriss was traced to the founder

The related-party identification was a **cross-document join within the company's own data room** — three separate documents each disclosed one leg, and the connection is the desk's:

1. **The team roster/bio** lists Amoriss among CEO Taylor Hou's founded ventures (alongside APM Help/Syndi and Fyxed).
2. **The KPI/sales snapshot** names Amoriss as the "first paying customer" commencing September 1, 2026 — with no related-party label *on that page*.
3. **The balance sheet** shows the founder-entity finance pattern: a \$450k converting loan from Syndi Co (Hou-affiliated, \$10M cap) and \$98k from Hou Ventures.

Joining (1) and (2) converts the traction headline into a related-party transaction; (3) establishes that founder entities already act as the company's lenders, making the customer-lender-channel concentration a single-person diligence surface. Credit where due: the facts are all *theirs* — the room disclosed each piece — but the pieces sit on different pages, and the join is the finding. This is the same method as the LZ Census-tier catch and the GEF charter read: nothing hidden, everything separated.

Independent verification status: OWED. State-registry confirmation of Amoriss's officers (expected Texas or Louisiana, matching Hou's other ventures) could not be completed — OpenCorporates and general web search are CAPTCHA-walled this session. Until a registry extract confirms Hou's officer/member role, the link rests on the company's own bio — a high-confidence source for an *adverse-to-them* admission, but the desk standard is a primary, and it's queued.

Epistemics audit: Mode-B status (added on principal challenge)

Executed Mode B (independent derivation, not their claims): the §889/200.216 regulatory analysis applied to their disclosed hardware; the EDGAR Form D negative search; entity-chain reconstruction. **Degraded to Mode A** (assigned but not independently completed): FCC equipment-authorization DB search (the physical-components check via grantee records); customs

import verification; the Knightscope base rate (cited from THEIR memo, not re-pulled from the 10-K); independent founder verification; first-principles demand derivation; M20 hardware unit-cost vs their gross-margin model. CAPTCHA-walled access explains part; the report previously blurred the distinction, which this section corrects.

Why the verdict stands: the PASS rests on the company's own adverse admissions — the one claim class actionable without external verification — and every degraded leg could only have deepened the adverse case or marginally improved traction; neither moves a pass at \$60M post.

Binding condition: if ANY reopen trigger fires, the full Mode-B battery above executes BEFORE any term discussion — no check is written on Mode-A diligence, however honest the room.

Open items (flagged, not silently dropped)

- FCC DA-26-786 / the cited Act: verify when press access recovers (both branches matter).
- Founder background vs independent sources: MED confidence, nothing adverse surfaced, but founder-primacy diligence is incomplete — the founder's entity web (Syndi/Amoriss/Fyxed) is simultaneously customer, channel, and lender, which concentrates the diligence surface on one person.
- Customs verification of actual robot import volumes (not reached this pass).
- Our data-room reads are logged by the company — they can see a thorough pass occurred.